

Aviv Gelfand

📍 Jerusalem, Israel

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in aviv-gelfand

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Summary

- Early-career Data Scientist with practical, result-oriented experience in DS roles across tech (production-grade), academia, military, and training. MSc in progress (HUJI, Data Science); BSc Statistics & Data Science (HUJI, GPA: 89).
- Proven ability to design and implement robust and impactful ML solutions, in complex real-world settings, combining high-level software engineering practices with close collaboration and rapid self-learning.
- Dedicated to long-term growth in a full-time role in a DS / ML Engineering team with a positive atmosphere where I can grow, contribute meaningfully, and help turn innovative ideas into reality.

Experience

Data Scientist

2024 – present

Darrow AI - Data Science Team

- Designed and deployed a robust production pipeline that uncovered \$1M+ lead. Leveraged few-shot Chain-of-Thought LLM prompting, optimised costs with OpenAI's Batch API, enriched and filtered lead databases with domain-specific intelligence, integrating multi-source web scraping.
- Performed numerous model evaluations and error analyses, collaborating with senior DSs, DEs, PMs, and other stakeholders.
- Worked with AWS environment, Airflow, Atlassian (JIRA), Elastic, OpenSearch, and relational tabular databases.

NLP Data Scientist & Research Assistant

2023 – 2024

Hebrew University of Jerusalem, Adi Leibovitch's Quantitative Legal Research lab

- Executed Supervised-Fine-Tuning of open-source LLMs to classify textual argument-types in trials; reduced labeling time and errors, replacing manual tagging with LLM-based tagging. Applied PEFT and LoRA with HF and PyTorch.
- Achieved over 90% accuracy and 80% F1 scores in most target labels. Saved days of model complexity and training time using efficient sampling, overcoming significant imbalance. Presented findings and achievements at a prominent statistics and data science conference in May 2024.

Statistics & Machine Learning Instructor

2022 – 2024

Upscale Analytics

- Built dozens of hands-on ML projects for a practical 12-week-long training in statistical inference and classic machine learning, with constant feedback from a Senior Data Scientist (and head lecturer), Michael Winer. Worked primarily with Scikit-Learn, SciPy, and XGBoost Libraries.
- Advanced from teaching assistant to instructor, then to a partner role. 3 successful semesters of weekly TA sessions with a significant presence of students.

Programmer & Research Assistant

2022 – 2023

Hebrew University of Jerusalem, Renana Peres's Computational Social Science Lab

- Self-taught and programmed smart contracts with a C++-based programming language, and developed a simulation interface (React.js). Designed and analyzed experiments, web-scraped data monthly, and did literature and academic peer reviews.

Data Analyst & Research Team Leader

2015 – 2020

Israel Defense Forces (Volunteered, Lieutenant)

- Conducted research, assessments, and analytics for high-ranked decision-makers and tripled teams' ongoing products.
- Led cross-organizational initiatives, achieving in-depth research papers via unprecedented cooperations between research branches.

Education

The Hebrew University of Jerusalem

2024 – 2026

MSc in Data Science — LLMs-focused Thesis, guided by Prof. Ariel Jaffe.

The Hebrew University of Jerusalem

2021 – 2024

BSc in Statistics & Data Science (GPA 89)

Skills and Technologies

Scripting Languages and Tools: Python, Java, Solidity (C++ based), R, SQL, JS, DataBricks

GenAI Tools: Prompt engineering (CoT, Few-Shot, etc), output schemas, fine-tuning open-source models

EDA & ETL: Visualizing, Cleaning, imputing, Encoding / Embedding; DataBricks, DataGrip, OpenSearch (Elastic)

ML & Stats: model evaluations, error analysis, robust measurement, efficient sampling, PEFT, LORA

CI/CD & Other: GIT, Docker, Aiflow, GitHub workflows, sh scripts, DataDog (on-call fun)